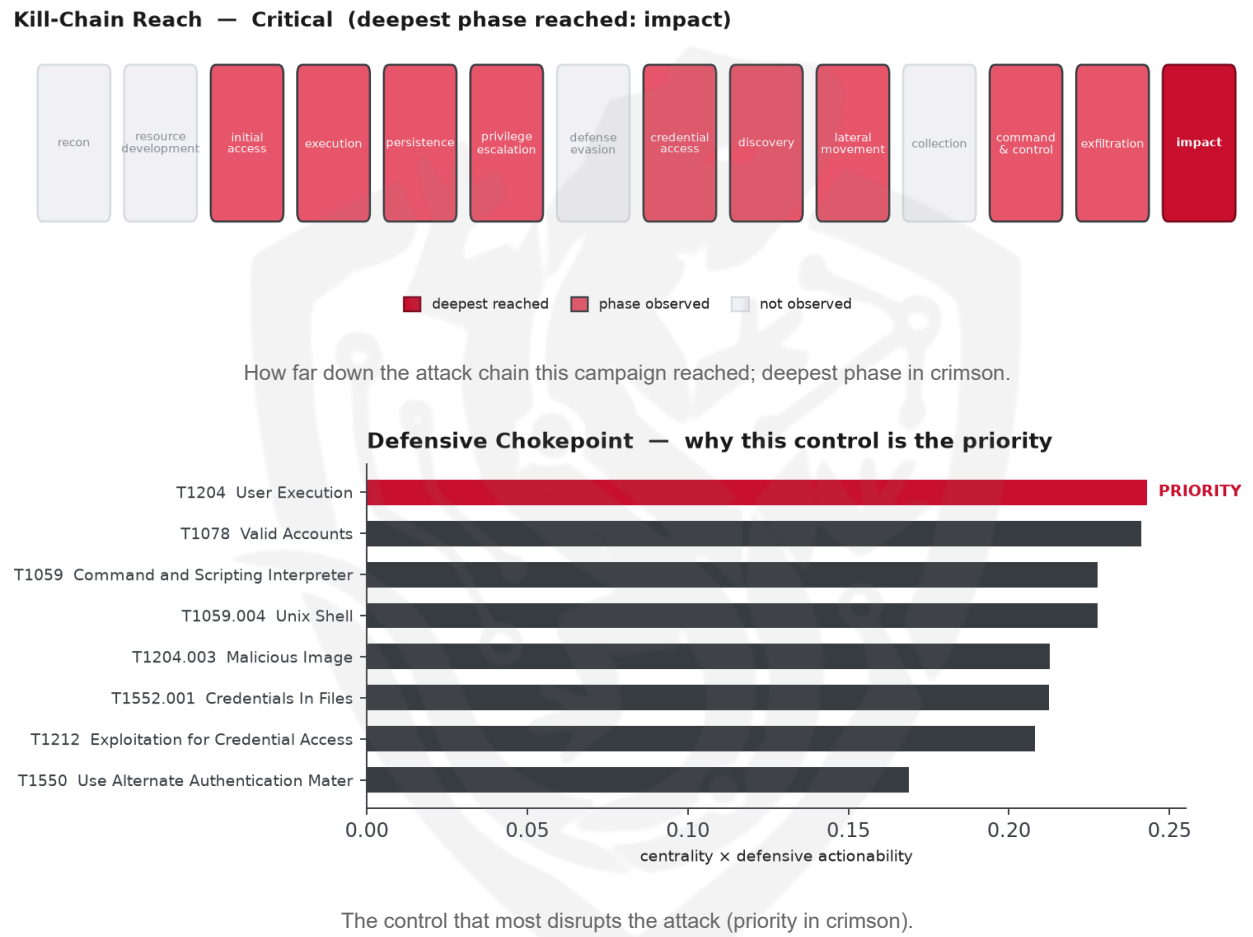


THREAT REPORT: UNKNOWN_ADVERSARY CAMPAIGN

Visual Summary



Summary

The observed cluster of activity is exploiting CVE-2026-33017, a vulnerability that poses a significant threat to the technology sector. The threat actor is targeting organizations in this sector, although the specific country and other details are not available. Priority should be given to patching the vulnerability and implementing additional controls to prevent exploitation. The campaign's impact is considered critical, reaching the level of operational risk.

Threat Overview

The threat actor, whose identity is not known, is exploiting the CVE-2026-33017 vulnerability, which is the central CVE in this campaign. The actor is using various techniques to gain access to systems and

exfiltrate data, but the specific malware families used are not available. The technology sector is the primary target of this campaign.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The observed techniques used by the threat actor form a complex chain, including local account manipulation, application layer protocol exploitation, and exfiltration over web services. The priority technique in this chain is T1204 User Execution, which is the graph chokepoint. To mitigate this threat, the top priority control is to: Patch CVE-2026-33017 on all affected systems as the top priority, then: Block execution of downloaded HTA/JS/LNK; enforce mark-of-the-web; disable Office macros from the internet; user awareness on lures.

Infrastructure and Corroboration

The malicious infrastructure associated with this campaign is hosted on CognetCloud Inc, according to third-party observations. Additionally, abuse.ch has corroborated the presence of VShell malware families in this campaign. However, AbusIPDB has not flagged any indicators with high confidence, with the highest confidence seen being only 1%.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1087.001 Local Account
- T1071 Application Layer Protocol
- T1190 Exploit Public-Facing Application
- T1567 Exfiltration Over Web Service
- T1552 Unsecured Credentials
- T1550 Use Alternate Authentication Material
- T1087 Account Discovery
- T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter
- T1083 File and Directory Discovery
- T1552.001 Credentials In Files
- T1204 User Execution
- T1212 Exploitation for Credential Access
- T1059.004 Unix Shell
- T1204.003 Malicious Image
- T1078 Valid Accounts
- T1571 Non-Standard Port
- T1496 Resource Hijacking
- T1071.001 Web Protocols
- T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer

- T1550.001 Application Access Token

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1204 User Execution (centrality 0.3037).
- Operational risk: Critical (score 1.0, reaches impact).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.3162; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
APT18	0.3162
Confucius	0.2958
APT33	0.2935
Rocke	0.2846
TeamTNT	0.284
### Enrichment Signal	
- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 1%.	
- Malware families corroborated by abuse.ch: VShell.	
- Note: enrichment raises the severity signal (an IOC at or above 80% AbuseIPDB confidence, or a confirmed malware-family hit). This is context, not a change to the source assessment.	

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator	Context
IP	45[.]207[.]216[.]55	AbuseIPDB 1% (HK) · VShell · AS401696 CognetCloud Inc
URL	hxxp://45[.]207[.]216[.]55:8084/slt	

Reputation by AbuseIPDB · malware attribution by abuse.ch · Geo/ASN data by IP2Location LITE.

